Low memory (RAM)

Virtualization means running multiple operating systems. If you have a system with insufficient memory installed, you might as well forget about virtualization. For example, if you have 1GB RAM and are running Windows 7, even with software like VirtualBox which is easy on resources, you won't be in a position to allocate any more than 256MB RAM for your VMs. So you can run Windows XP as a guest but there's no way you can try "Vista".

RAM is the first and the foremost requirement of virtualization. Without it, you're in no fair position to run virtual machines. Having less RAM and trying to use it to the maximum extent possible for virtualization makes the system prone to crashes. While testing a Ubuntu guest operating system with a Windows 7 host which has 1GB RAM while allocating 512 MB to the Ubuntu virtual machine on VirtualBox, the virtual machine crashed (it simply aborted) bringing down with it Google Chrome that was running on the host system. On another machine with the same amount of RAM, VMware Workstation as virtualization software and Windows 7 as the guest OS with 512 MB of virtual RAM and openSUSE as the host OS (running with firefox and LibreOffice Writer), the system almost froze and we had to switch to the command line to kill the VMware Workstation processes. In short, virtualization is not for computers with less memory. You can try it, but you can't expect high performance. You *can* expect your whole system to hang.

Apple's dramas

Mac runs on Apple hardware, only so if you're in all moods to test out a Mac OS X, we wish you best of luck. Though, our wishes aren't going to make Mac OS X run smoothly on a virtual hardware. Yes, you might just be able to run it, but the experience of the Mac OS X lies in its ability to make use of the great hardware features in Mac computers. There are tutorials and help all over the internet for all types of virtualization software to make them able enough to emulate Apple hardware correctly but you might just be getting into unnecessary trouble without results. Virtualization can't get a Mac OS X running, not easily at least! Apples and VMs don't mix well.

Gaming

Just because we mentioned NFS2SE and Mario doesn't mean they're definitely going to run. The ability to process graphics for gaming is an intense task and one with a high demand of parallelism. Virtualization is based on